

Configuration Migration

Series: M2S | **Notebook:** 5 of 8 | **Created:** January 2026 | **Last Updated:** 03/02/2026

Configuration migration is often the most time-consuming part of a Managed-to-SaaS migration. The [SaaS Upgrade Assistant](#) automates the bulk of this work, but a systematic approach ensures nothing is missed.

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Prerequisites

Before starting this notebook, you should have:

Requirement	Description
Completed M2S-01 to M2S-04	Architecture design complete
Source API Token	Managed token with <code>settings.read</code> , <code>dashboards.read</code>
Target API Token	SaaS token with <code>settings.write</code> , <code>dashboards.write</code>
Configuration inventory	List of items to migrate

Learning Objectives

By the end of this notebook, you will:

- Understand what configurations require migration
- Know how to use the Settings API for migration
- Be able to migrate dashboards between environments
- Migrate alerting and automation configurations

1. Introduction

What Migrates vs. What's Recreated

Category	Migration Method
Settings (via API)	SaaS Upgrade Assistant or Settings API
Dashboards	SaaS Upgrade Assistant or JSON export/import
Management Zones	SaaS Upgrade Assistant, Settings API, or manual
Alerting profiles	SaaS Upgrade Assistant or manual recreation
Notifications	Recreate (new webhook URLs)
Automations/Workflows	Recreate in SaaS Automations app

Migration Tooling Options

Choose the right tool for your migration complexity:

Tool	Best For	Description
SaaS Upgrade Assistant	Most migrations (recommended)	Automated export/import with UI, selective import, progress tracking, bulk editing
Monaco	Configuration as Code	Version-controlled configuration management, ideal for standardized deployments
Terraform	Infrastructure as Code	Dynatrace Terraform provider for programmatic management
Settings API	Custom automation	Direct API calls for maximum flexibility
Manual	Non-portable items	Credentials Vault, Cloud Platform Integrations

Warning: Do not mix tooling approaches. Monaco YAML templates can conflict with the SaaS Upgrade Assistant. Choose one primary method for consistency.

2. SaaS Upgrade Assistant Workflow

The **SaaS Upgrade Assistant** is a Dynatrace app that automates the majority of configuration migration. It handles dashboards, settings, alert policies, custom metrics, request attributes, network zones, and Settings 2.0 objects.

Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Managed version	1.294 or later
Version alignment	Same major version on Managed and SaaS recommended (e.g., both 1.294.x)
IAM policy	<code>upgrade-assistant:environments:write</code> assigned to migration users
Token scopes	<code>Read network zones</code> , <code>Write network zones</code> , <code>Capture request data</code>

Step-by-Step Workflow

Step 1: Export from Managed

1. Sign into the **Cluster Management Console** on your Managed cluster
2. Navigate to **Environments** and select the target environment
3. Select **Export Configuration** and confirm
4. The configuration archive is stored locally

Step 2: Upload to SaaS

1. Open the **SaaS Upgrade Assistant** app in your target SaaS tenant
2. Upload the exported configuration archive
3. The app validates the archive signature and processes all configurations

Step 3: Review Configurations

The app groups configurations by type with clear status indicators:

Status	Meaning	Action
Ready	Configuration can be deployed as-is	No action needed
Failed	Configuration has errors	Edit to fix, or exclude from deployment
Deployed	Already deployed to SaaS	No action needed

- Failed configurations are highlighted with full error messages (JSON-formatted)
- Cyclic dependency detection helps resolve configuration conflicts

Step 4: Edit Failed Configurations

Two editing modes are available:

Mode	Use Case
Single mode	Fix individual configurations with the edit form
Bulk mode	Update hundreds of configurations at once (e.g., updating all dashboard owners)

Tip: Use **Preview Changes** to verify edits before deploying. The app retains original values for rollback reference.

Step 5: Selective Import (Waved Approach)

The Smart Selective Import lets you deploy in waves:

1. **Select configuration types** to include or exclude per deployment
2. **Smart dependency management** automatically adds or removes dependent configurations
3. **Deploy incrementally** — start with foundational configs (management zones, tags), then build up

Recommended wave order:

Wave	Configuration Types
1	Management zones, auto-tagging rules, host groups
2	Service detection, request attributes, deep monitoring settings
3	Alerting profiles, anomaly detection, SLOs
4	Dashboards, remaining configurations

Step 6: Deploy and Track

1. Deploy selected configurations to SaaS
2. Monitor real-time progress via the upgrade status tracker
3. Download **deployment results** as CSV for auditing and validation
4. Review per-deployment and cumulative deployment summaries

What the SaaS Upgrade Assistant Handles

Configuration Type	Supported
Dashboards (with owner migration)	✓
Settings 2.0 objects	✓
Alert policies	✓
Custom metrics	✓
Request attributes	✓
Network zones	✓
Web/mobile user action configs	✓
Notification templates	✓

What Still Requires Manual Migration

Even with the SaaS Upgrade Assistant, these items need manual handling:

Item	Why
Credentials Vault entries	Security isolation—cannot be exported
Cloud platform integration credentials	Must be re-entered in SaaS
Problem notification webhooks	Endpoint URLs change for SaaS
API tokens	Tenant-specific—generate new ones
Synthetic private locations	Infrastructure-specific deployment

Monaco for Migration (Alternative)

Monaco (Monitoring as Code) is an alternative when the SaaS Upgrade Assistant is not suitable (e.g., tenant consolidation with name conflicts):

```
# Download configurations from Managed
monaco download \
  --environments managed.yaml \
  --project managed-export

# Deploy to SaaS (with transformation)
monaco deploy \
  --environments saas.yaml \
  --project managed-export
```

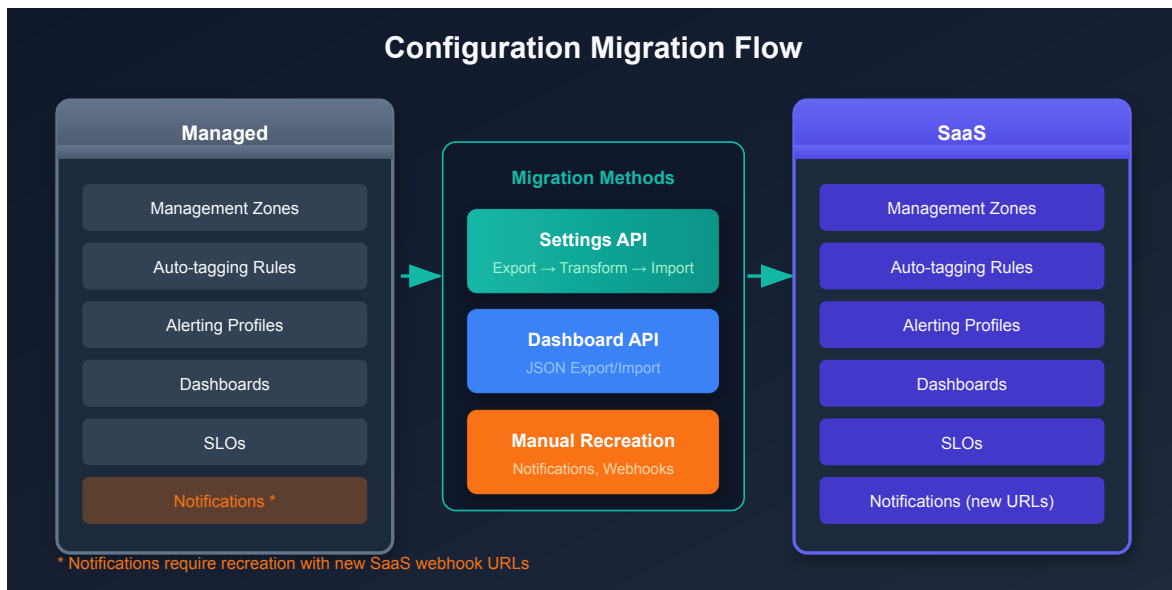
Terraform Provider (Alternative)

For organizations using Infrastructure as Code:

```
# Example: Management Zone in Terraform
resource "dynatrace_management_zone_v2" "production" {
  name = "Production"

  rules {
    type      = "PROCESS_GROUP"
    enabled = true

    attribute_rule {
      entity_type = "PROCESS_GROUP"
      conditions {
        key          = "PROCESS_GROUP_TAGS"
        operator     = "TAG_KEY_EQUALS"
        string_value = "environment:production"
      }
    }
  }
}
```



2. Configuration Categories

2.1 Portable vs Non-Portable Configurations

Understanding what can and cannot be automatically migrated is critical for planning.

Portable (API Migration)	Non-Portable (Manual Recreation)
Management Zones	Credentials Vault entries
Auto-tagging Rules	Cloud Platform Integration credentials
Host Groups	Problem Notification webhooks
Alerting Profiles	Custom SSL certificates
SLOs	ActiveGate configurations
Dashboards	Extension configurations (some)
Request Attributes	API tokens (must create new)
Service Detection Rules	User sessions/permissions

2.2 Core Platform Settings

Setting	Schema ID	Migration Complexity
Management Zones	<code>builtin:management-zones</code>	Medium
Auto-tagging Rules	<code>builtin:tags.auto-tagging</code>	Low
Host Groups	<code>builtin:host-monitoring.host-group</code>	Low
Process Groups	<code>builtin:process-group.monitoring</code>	Low
Frequent Issue Detection	<code>builtin:anomaly-detection.frequent-issues</code>	Low

2.3 Monitoring Settings

Setting	Schema ID	Migration Complexity
Service Detection	<code>builtin:service-detection.full-web-request</code>	Medium
Request Attributes	<code>builtin:request-attribute</code>	Medium
Calculated Services	<code>builtin:calculated-service-metric</code>	High
Calculated Metrics	<code>builtin:host.monitoring.metric.customization</code>	Medium
OneAgent Features	<code>builtin:oneagent.features</code>	Low
Deep Monitoring	<code>builtin:deep-monitoring</code>	Low

2.4 Alerting & Notifications

Setting	Schema ID	Migration Complexity
Alerting Profiles	<code>builtin:alerting.profile</code>	Medium
Problem Notifications	N/A (webhooks)	High - requires new URLs
Maintenance Windows	<code>builtin:alerting.maintenance-window</code>	Low
SLOs	<code>builtin:monitoring.slo</code>	Medium
Metric Events	<code>builtin:anomaly-detection.metric-events</code>	Medium

2.5 User Experience

Setting	Schema ID	Migration Complexity
Web Applications	<code>builtin:rum.web.application</code>	Medium
Mobile Applications	<code>builtin:rum.mobile.application</code>	Medium
Session Replay	<code>builtin:session-replay</code>	Low
User Action Naming	<code>builtin:rum.web.user-action-custom-naming</code>	Medium
Key User Actions	<code>builtin:rum.web.key-user-actions</code>	Medium

2.6 Non-Portable Configurations (Manual Effort Required)

 These items CANNOT be migrated via API and require manual recreation:

Configuration	Why Non-Portable	Action Required
Credentials Vault	Security isolation	Re-enter all credentials in SaaS
Cloud Platform Integrations	Credential-dependent	Reconfigure AWS/Azure/GCP connections
Problem Notifications	Endpoint changes	Create new webhooks with SaaS URLs
API Tokens	Tenant-specific	Generate new tokens in SaaS
SSL Certificates	Tenant-specific	Upload certificates to SaaS
Extensions 2.0	Some require reconfiguration	Review each extension
Synthetic Private Locations	Infrastructure-specific	Deploy new Synthetic ActiveGates

3. Settings API Migration

3.1 Export Settings from Managed

Use the Settings API to export configurations:

```
# Export Management Zones
curl -X GET "https://{managed-url}/e/{env-id}/api/v2/settings/objects?
schemaIds=builtin:management-zones&pageSize=500" \
  -H "Authorization: Api-Token {token}" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  > management-zones-export.json
```

3.2 Transform for SaaS

Before importing, you may need to:

1. **Remove object IDs** - Let SaaS generate new IDs
2. **Update entity references** - Managed entity IDs differ from SaaS
3. **Adjust scope** - Some scopes may differ

3.3 Import to SaaS

```
# Import Management Zones to SaaS
curl -X POST "https://{tenant}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/settings/objects" \
  -H "Authorization: Api-Token {saas-token}" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d @management-zones-import.json
```

3.4 Common Schema IDs for Migration

Purpose	Schema ID
Management Zones	<code>builtin:management-zones</code>
Auto-tagging	<code>builtin:tags.auto-tagging</code>
Alerting profiles	<code>builtin:alerting.profile</code>
Maintenance windows	<code>builtin:alerting.maintenance-window</code>
SLOs	<code>builtin:monitoring.slo</code>
Request attributes	<code>builtin:request-attribute</code>

4. Dashboard Migration

4.1 Export Dashboards from Managed

```
# List all dashboards
curl -X GET "https://{managed-url}/e/{env-id}/api/config/v1/dashboards" \
  -H "Authorization: Api-Token {token}" \
  > dashboards-list.json

# Export specific dashboard
curl -X GET "https://{managed-url}/e/{env-id}/api/config/v1/dashboards/{dashboard-id}" \
  -H "Authorization: Api-Token {token}" \
  > dashboard-export.json
```

4.2 Dashboard Transformation

Before importing dashboards:

Issue	Solution
Entity IDs hardcoded	Replace with entity selectors
Management Zone IDs	Update to SaaS MZ IDs
Dashboard ID	Remove (let SaaS generate)
Owner	Update to SaaS user

4.3 Import to SaaS

```
# Import dashboard to SaaS
curl -X POST "https://{tenant}.live.dynatrace.com/api/config/v1/dashboards" \
  -H "Authorization: Api-Token {saas-token}" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d @dashboard-import.json
```

4.4 Dashboard Validation Queries

After migration, verify dashboards are working:

```
// Verify data exists for dashboard queries
// Run sample queries from your dashboards to confirm data availability
fetch logs, from:-1h
| summarize count()
| fieldsAdd status = if(`count()` > 0, then: "Data available", else: "No data")
```

5. Alerting Migration

5.1 Alerting Profiles

Alerting profiles can be exported via Settings API:

```
# Export alerting profiles
curl -X GET "https://{managed-url}/e/{env-id}/api/v2/settings/objects?
schemaIds=builtin:alerting.profile" \
-H "Authorization: Api-Token {token}" \
> alerting-profiles.json
```

5.2 Problem Notifications

Problem notifications **must be recreated** because:

- Webhook URLs change (new SaaS endpoints)
- Integration IDs are different
- Some integrations have new configuration options

Integration Type	Migration Action
Email	Recreate recipients
Slack	New webhook URL
Microsoft Teams	New webhook URL
PagerDuty	Update integration key
ServiceNow	New instance URL
Custom webhook	Update URL to new endpoint

5.3 Anomaly Detection Settings

Export and import via Settings API:

Schema	Purpose
<code>builtin:anomaly-detection.services</code>	Service anomaly detection
<code>builtin:anomaly-detection.infrastructure-hosts</code>	Host anomaly detection
<code>builtin:anomaly-detection.infrastructure-disks</code>	Disk anomaly detection

6. Automation Migration

6.1 Workflows (Automations)

SaaS uses the Automations app for workflows. If migrating from Managed with custom automation:

Managed Feature	SaaS Equivalent
Problem notifications	Workflow triggers
Custom webhooks	HTTP Request action
Metric events	Event triggers

6.2 Recreating Automations

1. Document existing automation logic from Managed
2. Create new workflow in SaaS Automations app
3. Configure triggers (problem, event, schedule)
4. Add actions (HTTP requests, scripts, etc.)
5. Test with synthetic events

6.3 API-Based Automations

If you have scripts calling Dynatrace APIs:

Change Required	Details
Base URL	<code>{tenant}.live.dynatrace.com</code>
API Token	New SaaS token
Environment ID	Not needed for SaaS
API version	Verify endpoint compatibility

Configuration Migration Checklist

Portable Configurations (Settings API)

Category	Schema ID	Status
Management Zones	<code>builtin:management-zones</code>	<code>[]</code>
Auto-tagging Rules	<code>builtin:tags.auto-tagging</code>	<code>[]</code>
Host Groups	<code>builtin:host-monitoring.host-group</code>	<code>[]</code>
Alerting Profiles	<code>builtin:alerting.profile</code>	<code>[]</code>
Maintenance Windows	<code>builtin:alerting.maintenance-window</code>	<code>[]</code>
SLOs	<code>builtin:monitoring.slo</code>	<code>[]</code>
Request Attributes	<code>builtin:request-attribute</code>	<code>[]</code>
Service Detection	<code>builtin:service-detection.full-web-request</code>	<code>[]</code>
Calculated Services	<code>builtin:calculated-service-metric</code>	<code>[]</code>
Anomaly Detection	<code>builtin:anomaly-detection.services</code>	<code>[]</code>
Web Applications	<code>builtin:rum.web.application</code>	<code>[]</code>
Mobile Applications	<code>builtin:rum.mobile.application</code>	<code>[]</code>
User Action Naming	<code>builtin:rum.web.user-action-custom-naming</code>	<code>[]</code>
Key User Actions	<code>builtin:rum.web.key-user-actions</code>	<code>[]</code>
Session Properties	<code>builtin:rum.web.session-properties</code>	<code>[]</code>
OneAgent Features	<code>builtin:oneagent.features</code>	<code>[]</code>

Dashboard Migration

Item	Status
Export all dashboards from Managed	[]
Transform entity references	[]
Remove hardcoded IDs	[]
Import to SaaS	[]
Validate dashboard data	[]

Non-Portable Configurations (Manual Recreation)

Item	Action Required	Status
Credentials Vault	Re-enter all credentials	[]
Cloud Platform Integrations	Reconfigure with new credentials	[]
Problem Notifications	Create new webhooks with SaaS URLs	[]
API Tokens	Generate new tokens	[]
SSL Certificates	Upload to SaaS	[]
Extensions 2.0	Review and reconfigure	[]
Synthetic Private Locations	Deploy new Synthetic ActiveGates	[]
Custom Services	Verify or recreate	[]

Automation Migration

Item	Status
Document existing automation logic	[]
Create workflows in Automations app	[]
Configure triggers	[]
Update API scripts with new URLs/tokens	[]
Test all automations	[]

8. Next Steps

Immediate Actions

1. **Export configurations** - Use the [SaaS Upgrade Assistant](#) to export from Managed
2. **Upload and review** - Upload archive to SaaS and review configuration status
3. **Deploy in waves** - Use selective import to deploy foundational configs first
4. **Fix failed configs** - Use bulk or single edit mode for any failures
5. **Recreate notifications** - Set up integrations with new SaaS URLs
6. **Download deploy results** - CSV reports for auditing and validation

Continue the Series

Next Notebook	Focus
M2S-06: OneAgent & ActiveGate Migration	Agent migration procedures

Configuration Resources

- [SaaS Upgrade Assistant Documentation](#)
- [SaaS Upgrade Assistant on Dynatrace Hub](#)
- [Settings API Reference](#)
- [Dashboard API](#)

- [Automations Documentation](#)
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Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

- The SaaS Upgrade Assistant workflow for automated configuration migration
- Configuration categories and their migration methods
- How to use selective import for waved deployments
- How to handle failed configurations with bulk and single edit modes
- Dashboard migration and ownership transformation
- Why notifications must be recreated
- Automation migration considerations

Key Takeaway: The [SaaS Upgrade Assistant](#) automates the majority of configuration migration—dashboards, settings, alert policies, and more. Use it as your primary tool, then handle non-portable items (credentials, webhooks) manually.

Continue to M2S-06: OneAgent & ActiveGate Migration for agent migration procedures.

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